

Chittur Delegation to Thiruvananthapuram — 15 July 2026

Delegation: Representatives of the **Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara**, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District, Kerala.

Accompanied by: **Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA** — Chittur (Constituency No. 58), Kerala Legislative Assembly.

Purpose: To submit petitions and request the concerned Ministers to expedite action on five issues affecting the Chittur Assembly constituency, and in particular the rain-shadow panchayats of **Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara**.

Index of Petitions and Ministers to be met

#	Subject	Primary Minister	Copies to
1	Raise the sanctioned agricultural EB connection to 5 HP for deep borewells in the rain-shadow belt	Minister for Electricity (Sunny Joseph)	Minister for Agriculture (T. Siddique); Minister for Water Resources (Mons Joseph)
2	Renewal / review of the Parambikulam–Aliyar Project (PAP) agreement and realisation of Kerala's assured Chitturpuzha share	Minister for Water Resources (Mons Joseph)	Hon'ble Chief Minister (V.D. Satheesan) — holds <i>Inter-State River Waters</i>
3	Dairy processing / cattle-feed / semen-preservation / veterinary college for Chittur and productivity improvement	Minister for Animal Husbandry & Dairy Development (Bindu Krishna)	Minister for Co-operation (M. Liju)
4	Special status / pollution-category parity for the coir (de-fibring & pith) industry in Chittur	Minister for Industries (P.K. Kunhalikutty)	Minister for Coir (Ramesh Chennithala); Chairman, Kerala State Pollution Control Board
5	Simplify fertilizer (urea) procurement for genuine farmers while preventing diversion	Minister for Co-operation (M. Liju)	Minister for Agriculture (T. Siddique); Minister for Food & Civil Supplies (Anoop Jacob)

Note on facts and figures

These drafts were prepared using publicly reported data (Central Ground Water Board, Kerala Ground Water Department, Kerala Irrigation Department / KIIDC, Milma/MRCMPU, CPCB/TNPCB, Department of Fertilizers). A few figures in the original brief were corrected against the record:

- **Rainfall** is measured in **millimetres (mm)**, not centimetres. Chittur's rain-shadow belt gets roughly **≤1,000 mm** a year against Kerala's average of about **3,000 mm** — i.e. about one-third.
- The bottling-plant water controversy referred to is the **Plachimada (Coca-Cola) case in Perumatty panchayat**, Chittur — used here as background to the restrictive groundwater regime.
- **PAP water figures** are stated using documented entitlements (**7.25 TMC / 7,250 mcft** at Manakadavu weir) rather than the "90 / 12.5 TMC" figures in the brief.

Before printing on the Society's letterhead, please fill in the bracketed blanks [...] (names, signatories, phone, membership numbers), attach the noted annexures, and, where useful, add a Malayalam translation. Any Government Order (G.O.) numbers should be verified with the MLA's office / department for the latest reference.

Government Order references and templates

Each English petition now (a) cites the **exact Government Order / statutory instrument** inline (e.g. *G.O.(P) No. 58/2005/WRD dated 19-11-2005* notifying Chittoor under the Kerala Ground Water Act; *KSEB Board Circular dated 05-06-*

2007; *CPCB Directions dated 07-03-2016*; the *Fertilizer (Control) Order, 1985*; the *PAP agreement dated 29-05-1970*), and (b) ends with a **model "Draft Government Order"** in Kerala G.O. format that the Minister may adopt (the actual G.O. number/date/file references are left blank for the Department to assign).

Language versions

- **English:** the numbered files in this folder (01–05) and 00-README.
- **Malayalam (മലയാളം):** ml/ sub-folder.
- **Tamil (தமிழ்):** ta/ sub-folder.

PDFs for all three languages are generated into pdf/ by build-petitions-pdf.py.

The individual petitions are in the numbered files in this folder.

Petition 1 — Enhancement of Agricultural Electricity Connection to 5 HP for Deep Borewells in the Chittur Rain-Shadow Belt

To: Shri Sunny Joseph Hon'ble Minister for Electricity, Government of Kerala Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: 1. Shri T. Siddique, Hon'ble Minister for Agriculture 2. Shri Mons Joseph, Hon'ble Minister for Water Resources (Irrigation & Ground Water)

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Request to permit and expedite agricultural electricity connections up to **5 HP** (and, where justified, above 5 HP) for deep irrigation borewells in the rain-shadow panchayats of Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy, Kozhinjampara and adjoining areas of the Chittur block.

1. Respected Sir,

We are farmer-representatives of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara. We respectfully place before you the acute irrigation-power difficulty faced by the farmers of the eastern, rain-shadow part of the Chittur Assembly constituency, and pray for your intervention.

2. The factual position

- 1. Kerala's driest belt.** Chittur — and in particular Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara — lies in the Palakkad Gap **rain-shadow region**, the driest tract in Kerala. Annual rainfall here is only about **1,000 mm (and often less)**, against the State average of roughly **3,000 mm** — barely **one-third** of the State average. The surrounding hills block the rain-bearing winds.
- 2. A "Critical" groundwater block.** As per the Central Ground Water Board's *National Compilation on Dynamic Ground Water Resources of India (2023 and 2024)*, **Chittur is one of only two or three "Critical" groundwater blocks in the entire State of Kerala** (along with Malampuzha and Kasaragod), where the stage of groundwater extraction is between 90% and 100%.
- 3. Deepening borewells.** Because surface water is scarce and rainfall is low, farmers depend almost entirely on borewells. Water tables have fallen steeply — borewells that were once 400–600 ft now increasingly **cross 800–1,000 ft** in these panchayats.
- 4. The power bottleneck — the exact legal position.** Following the groundwater regime tightened after the Plachimada (Perumatty panchayat) bottling-plant water controversy: - Under the **Kerala Ground Water (Control and Regulation) Act, 2002 (Act 19 of 2003)** and the **Kerala Ground Water (Control and Regulation) Rules, 2004**, the Government, exercising powers under **Section 6(1)**, notified certain areas as "notified areas." By **G.O.(P) No. 58/2005/WRD dated 19-11-2005**, **Chittoor (Palakkad District) was declared a notified area** (along with Athiyannur, Kodungalloor, Kozhikode and Kasaragode). - Consequently, under **Section 7** of the Act, extraction of groundwater in Chittoor requires a **permit from the Kerala State Ground Water Authority**. - By **KSEB Board Circular dated 05-06-2007 (Circular_Control_05-06-2007)**, the Board directed that an **electric connection to any open well / borewell within a notified area shall be given only on production of the Ground Water Authority permit**, treating that permit as a statutory clearance — in line with the proviso to **Clause 6(1) of the Kerala Electricity Supply Code** (now the **Kerala Electricity Supply Code, 2014**). - Under the Ground Water Department's operating practice, the **District-level committee sanctions motors only in the 3–5 HP band**, and motors **above 5 HP require State-level authority** approval, so in practice farmers in this belt are effectively held at around **3 HP**, with long delays for anything higher. - Further, before the borewell / EB line is

approved, the **Ground Water Authority requires the farmer to install a water flow meter on the well and submit its readings**, and grants the extraction/conversion permit **subject to a ceiling on daily extraction** fixed on the basis of a **yield test**. In our critical-zone belt these flow-meter, daily-log and yield-test conditions are difficult and impractical for small and marginal farmers to comply with and add further delay to obtaining the EB connection.

5. **Why 3 HP is not enough.** A 3 HP pump simply cannot lift adequate water from a borewell that is 800–1,000 ft deep. The result is that farms cannot be irrigated even where a valid well exists, causing crop loss and distress among paddy, banana, coconut and vegetable growers who have no alternative source of water.

3. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister to:

1. **Sanction agricultural EB connections up to 5 HP as the norm** for genuine cultivators in Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy, Kozhinjampara (and comparable critical-zone areas of Chittur block) where the certified borewell depth exceeds a reasonable threshold (e.g. 500/800 ft), on production of the Ground Water Authority permit.
2. **Expedite and simplify** clearances for connections **above 5 HP** in genuinely deep borewells, on the basis of a well-depth certificate, without routine referral delays.
3. Establish a **single-window** so that the Ground Water Authority permit and the KSEB connection are processed together within a fixed time limit.
4. **Retain the concessional LT-VA agricultural tariff** for these enhanced-HP irrigation connections.
5. **Make the flow-meter, daily-log and yield-test conditions practical** — for genuine small and marginal farmers in these panchayats, simplify or relax the mandatory flow-meter installation and daily-reading requirement (e.g. a one-time meter with periodic reading, or exemption below a threshold HP/depth), and fix crop-based, realistic daily-extraction ceilings, so that these conditions do not delay or block the EB connection.
6. Consider **dedicated agricultural feeders and solar-pump support (PM-KUSUM / State schemes)** so that the higher connected load does not raise the farmer's cost, and to make deep-borewell irrigation energy-efficient (paired with drip/micro-irrigation).

We are willing to furnish panchayat-wise lists of affected farmers, borewell-depth data and pending connection applications.

4. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Panchayat-wise list of affected farmers and pending/limited connections.
- Annexure B: Borewell depth certificates / sample.
- Annexure C: CGWB categorisation extract for Chittur block.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur

Annexure — Draft Government Order (model, for the Government's consideration)

The following is a model draft placed for the Government's consideration. The actual G.O. number, date and file references are to be assigned by the Department.

GOVERNMENT OF KERALA

Abstract

Power (Electricity) Department — Agricultural electric connections in the notified "critical" ground-water areas of Chittoor block, Palakkad District — Enhancement of permissible motor capacity up to 5 HP for deep bore-wells and single-window clearance — Sanctioned — Orders issued.

POWER (ELECTRICITY) DEPARTMENT

G.O.(Ms) No. ____/2026/PD Thiruvananthapuram, dated __-__-2026

Read: 1. The Kerala Ground Water (Control and Regulation) Act, 2002 (Act 19 of 2003) and Rules, 2004.
2. G.O.(P) No. 58/2005/WRD dated 19-11-2005 (notified areas).
3. KSEB Board Circular dated 05-06-2007.
4. Representation dated 15-07-2026 of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, forwarded by the MLA, Chittur.

ORDER

Whereas Chittoor block is a notified area under the Act read above (2) and one of the "Critical" ground-water blocks of the State; and whereas bore-wells in Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara now commonly exceed 800–1,000 ft, for which a 3 HP pump-set is technically insufficient;

Government, having considered the matter, hereby order that —

- (1) KSEB Ltd. shall sanction agricultural (LT-VA) connections up to 5 HP as a matter of course to genuine cultivators in the said panchayats, on production of the Ground Water Authority permit, where the certified bore-well depth exceeds [500/800] ft;
- (2) applications for connections above 5 HP for genuinely deep bore-wells shall be disposed by the State Ground Water Authority within [30] days on the basis of a well-depth certificate;
- (3) a single-window mechanism shall process the GWA permit and the KSEB connection together within a fixed time-limit;
- (4) the Ground Water Authority's flow-meter, daily-log and yield-test conditions shall be made practical for small/marginal farmers (one-time meter with periodic reading or exemption below a threshold; realistic, crop-based daily-extraction ceilings) so as not to delay the EB line;
- (5) the concessional LT-VA agricultural tariff shall continue to apply; and
- (6) the Department shall examine dedicated agricultural feeders / PM-KUSUM solar-pump support for the belt.

By order of the Governor,

Secretary to Government

To The Chairman & Managing Director, KSEB Ltd.

The Member Secretary, Kerala State Ground Water Authority.

Copy to: Agriculture Dept.; Water Resources Dept.; the MLA, Chittur.

Petition 2 — Renewal / Review of the Parambikulam–Aliyar Project (PAP) Agreement and Realisation of Kerala's Assured Chitturpuzha Share

To: Shri Mons Joseph Hon'ble Minister for Water Resources (Irrigation, CADA & Ground Water), Government of Kerala
Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: Shri V.D. Satheesan, Hon'ble Chief Minister of Kerala (holding the *Inter-State River Waters* portfolio)

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by
[Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Urgent renewal / review of the Parambikulam–Aliyar Project (PAP) agreement between Kerala and Tamil Nadu,
and guaranteed realisation of Kerala's assured water share for the Chitturpuzha valley.

1. Respected Sir,

The single most important lifeline for the farmers of the Chittur rain-shadow belt is the water of the **Chitturpuzha**, a tributary of the Bharathapuzha, fed under the inter-State **Parambikulam–Aliyar Project (PAP)** agreement with Tamil Nadu. We pray for the State's urgent intervention to renew this long-overdue agreement and to secure the water that is rightfully ours.

2. Why Chittur has no alternative

Chittur is the **eastern-most** agricultural tract of Kerala. Almost every river rising in the Western Ghats flows **westward**; **no west-flowing river can reach** the eastern panchayats of Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara. Combined with the lowest rainfall in the State (about 1,000 mm against Kerala's ~3,000 mm average), this makes the assured release under the PAP agreement — chiefly through the **Manakadavu weir** into the Chitturpuzha and thence the **Moolathara barrage / Right Bank Canal** — the **only** dependable surface-water source for this region. The waters of the Chittur valley were historically developed to serve the Chittur tract of the erstwhile **Cochin (Kochi) State**; the command that this water must serve has since expanded well beyond that original region.

3. The agreement and its shortfall — the facts

- 1. The agreement.** The PAP agreement was signed between Kerala and Tamil Nadu on **29 May 1970**, with **retrospective effect from 9 November 1958**. Being an inter-State river-water matter, it falls within the framework of the **Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956** and Entry 56 of the Union List / Article 262 of the Constitution — a subject held at the level of the **Hon'ble Chief Minister (Inter-State River Waters portfolio)**.
- 2. Renewal is decades overdue.** The agreement contains a clause for **review every 30 years**, i.e. it was **due for review in 1988**. Despite many rounds of official- and political-level talks, it **has still not been renewed** — a delay now of nearly four decades.
- 3. Kerala's assured share is not being received.** Under the agreement, Kerala is entitled to about **7,250 million cubic feet (≈ 7.25 TMC)** of water per water year (1 July – 10 June) at the **Manakadavu weir** for the Chitturpuzha, in addition to an entitlement of about **2.5 TMC from the Parambikulam group of reservoirs for the exclusive use of the Chitturpuzha valley**. In practice, actual releases fall far short: - In the **2023–24 water year**, Kerala received **only about 3,573 mcft** (as reported to the Assembly up to January 2024) — roughly **half** the assured 7,250 mcft. - The **Kerala Legislative Assembly Ad-hoc Committee on the Parambikulam–Mullaperiyar water-sharing agreement (Report, 1994)** recorded that Kerala had received only about **15.9 TMC against a due share of 41.75 TMC**.

4. **Structural cause.** Following the construction of the chain of PAP dams and diversions, the natural flow that once reached the Chitturpuzha valley has been substantially curtailed; assured flows at Manakadavu and Sholayar are not being honoured in low-yield years, and Tamil Nadu has proposed further diversions without Kerala's concurrence.

4. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister, and through him the Hon'ble Chief Minister (who holds the Inter-State River Waters portfolio), to:

1. **Accord top priority to the renewal / review of the PAP agreement**, which has been overdue since 1988, and pursue it at the Chief-Minister level with Tamil Nadu.
2. **Insist on full realisation of the assured 7,250 mcft (7.25 TMC) at the Manakadavu weir**, with **telemetry / measuring stations and a transparent monitoring mechanism** to guarantee the flow, especially in the critical summer months and in low-yield years.
3. Press Tamil Nadu to **release water from the Parambikulam reservoir to Aliyar and onward to Manakadavu**, and to honour the 2.5 TMC exclusive Chitturpuzha-valley entitlement.
4. **Reconstitute and reconvene the joint (secretary-level) Kerala–Tamil Nadu committee**; and, should Tamil Nadu remain unresponsive, examine recourse to a **statutory tribunal / Union Government (Ministry of Jal Shakti) mediation** under the inter-State river-water framework.
5. **Complete and extend the Moolathara Right Bank Canal micro-irrigation project** so that the assured water actually reaches the tail-end fields of Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara.

5. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Copy of the 1970 PAP agreement (relevant clauses).
- Annexure B: Year-wise data of assured vs. actual releases at Manakadavu weir.
- Annexure C: Map of the Chitturpuzha command and the eastern panchayats.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur

Annexure — Draft Government Order (model, for the Government's consideration)

The following is a model draft placed for the Government's consideration. The actual G.O. number, date and file references are to be assigned by the Department.

GOVERNMENT OF KERALA
Abstract

Water Resources Department — Parambikulam–Aliyar Project (PAP) inter-State agreement dated 29-05-1970 with Tamil Nadu — Review/renewal (due since 1988) and realisation of Kerala's assured Chitturpuzha share at Manakadavu weir — Constitution of negotiating committee and installation of telemetry — Orders issued.

WATER RESOURCES (INTER-STATE WATERS) DEPARTMENT
G.O.(Ms) No. ____/2026/WRD Thiruvananthapuram, dated __-__-2026

Read: 1. The Parambikulam–Aliyar Project agreement dated 29-05-1970 (effective 09-11-1958), Article on review after 30 years.

2. Report (1994) of the Kerala Legislative Assembly Ad-hoc Committee on the Parambikulam–Mullaperiyar agreement.
3. The Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956.
4. Representation dated 15-07-2026 of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, forwarded by the MLA, Chittur.

ORDER

Whereas the review of the PAP agreement, due after 30 years (i.e. in 1988), remains pending; and whereas Kerala's assured entitlement of 7,250 mcft (≈7.25 TMC) at the Manakadavu weir for the Chitturpuzha is not being realised (only ≈3,573 mcft received in the 2023–24 water year);

Government, having considered the matter, hereby order that —

- (1) the State shall accord top priority, at the Chief-Minister level, to the review/renewal of the PAP agreement with the Government of Tamil Nadu;
- (2) a Kerala–Tamil Nadu joint (Secretary-level) negotiating committee shall be (re)constituted to conclude the review within a time-bound schedule;
- (3) the Water Resources Department shall install telemetry/measuring stations at the Manakadavu weir and Sholayar to verify and guarantee the assured flows, including in low-yield years and summer months;
- (4) the State shall press for the 2.5 TMC exclusive Chitturpuzha-valley share and, failing a favourable response, examine recourse to the Union Government / a statutory tribunal under the Act read above (3); and
- (5) the Moolathara Right Bank Canal micro-irrigation extension serving Eruthempathy/Vadakarapathy/Kozhinjampara shall be expedited.

By order of the Governor,

Secretary to Government

To The Chief Secretary; the Principal Secretary, Water Resources.

Copy to: the Hon'ble Chief Minister's Office (Inter-State River Waters); the Chief Engineer (IDRB); the MLA, Chittur.

Petition 3 — Dairy Processing, Cattle-Feed, Semen-Preservation and Veterinary Education Infrastructure for Chittur, and Measures to Improve Cattle Productivity

To: Smt. Bindu Krishna Hon'ble Minister for Animal Husbandry & Dairy Development and Milk Co-operatives, Government of Kerala (also in charge of the Kerala Veterinary & Animal Sciences University) Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: Shri M. Liju, Hon'ble Minister for Co-operation

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Request to establish dairy value-addition / processing, cattle-feed manufacturing, semen-preservation and veterinary-education facilities in the Chittur belt, and to support measures that raise cattle productivity.

1. Respected Madam,

Chittur is among the foremost milk-producing regions of Kerala, yet the dairy-processing and support infrastructure has not kept pace with production. We pray for facilities that will let our dairy farmers capture more value close to home.

2. The factual position

- 1. A leading milk region.** Palakkad district — with the Chittur belt as a major contributor — records daily milk collection of the order of **3 lakh litres**, among the highest in the State, sustained by around **30,000 dairy farmers** organised into **300-plus primary dairy co-operative societies**.
- 2. Existing capacity is concentrated elsewhere in the district.** The Milma / MRCMPU **Palakkad Dairy at Kallepully** (commissioned 1967) and the **cattle-feed plant at Malampuzha** serve the district, and a straw-baling unit operates at Pattanchery. However, the **eastern Chittur belt (Kozhinjampara / Eruthempathy / Vadakarapathy)** has **little or no dedicated milk-processing / value-addition capacity of its own**, so much of the milk leaves the region as raw milk with limited local value addition.
- 3. Missing links.** There is **no dedicated frozen-semen / bull station or semen-preservation and AI-strengthening centre** in the Chittur region (frozen-semen production is concentrated at the **Kerala Livestock Development Board (KLDB)** stations elsewhere in the State), and there is **no Veterinary and Animal Sciences College in Palakkad district** — the campuses of the **Kerala Veterinary and Animal Sciences University (KVASU)**, established under the **Kerala Veterinary and Animal Sciences University Act, 2010**, are far away (Pookode, Wayanad; Mannuthy, Thrissur). The dairy co-operative structure functions through Milma / MRCMPU under the **Kerala Co-operative Societies Act, 1969**. This limits both productivity support to farmers and skilled veterinary manpower locally.

3. Our prayer

Given Chittur's standing as a top milk-producing region, we humbly request that **at least one — and ideally a cluster — of the following be sanctioned for the Chittur belt:**

- 1. A modern dairy products / value-addition and processing plant** (curd, ghee, paneer, flavoured milk, milk powder / value-added products), or a major capacity expansion, located in the Chittur belt so that farmers realise better prices locally.

2. A **cattle-feed manufacturing unit** in Chittur, leveraging locally available maize and agricultural residues, to reduce feed cost — the single largest cost in dairying.
3. A **frozen-semen / bull station or semen-preservation and Artificial Insemination (AI) strengthening centre**, with embryo-transfer and sexed-semen facilities, to improve herd genetics.
4. A **Veterinary and Animal Sciences College (KVASU campus)** in Palakkad / Chittur, to provide local veterinary services, extension and skilled manpower.

4. Measures to improve cattle productivity (requested support)

- Promotion of **green-fodder and maize / azolla cultivation** and **Total Mixed Ration (TMR)** in the fodder-scarce, rain-shadow belt, with fodder-development subsidy.
- Wider distribution of **mineral mixture, bypass protein feed** and quality **pellet feed** at subsidised rates.
- **Bulk milk coolers (BMCs)** and chilling points in the eastern panchayats to cut spoilage in the hot climate.
- **High-genetic-merit / sexed semen**, herd-health camps, mastitis control and deworming drives.
- **Cattle insurance** and interest-subvention linked dairy loans through the co-operative sector.

5. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Society-wise milk procurement data for the Chittur belt.
- Annexure B: Proposed site options for the plant / centre.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur

Annexure — Draft Government Order (model, for the Government's consideration)

The following is a model draft placed for the Government's consideration. The actual G.O. number, date and file references are to be assigned by the Department.

GOVERNMENT OF KERALA
Abstract

Animal Husbandry & Dairy Development Department — Chittur (Palakkad), a leading milk-producing region — Establishment of dairy value-addition / cattle-feed / semen-preservation facilities and a Veterinary College, and productivity measures — Administrative sanction accorded — Orders issued.

ANIMAL HUSBANDRY & DAIRY DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT
G.O.(Ms) No. ____/2026/AHD Thiruvananthapuram, dated __-__-2026

Read: 1. The Kerala Veterinary and Animal Sciences University Act, 2010.
2. The Kerala Co-operative Societies Act, 1969 (Milma/MRCMPU).
3. Representation dated 15-07-2026 of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, forwarded by the MLA, Chittur.

ORDER

Whereas Palakkad district, with the Chittur belt as a major contributor, records daily milk collection of the order of 3 lakh litres sustained by about 30,000 dairy farmers, yet lacks dedicated processing/value-addition, cattle-feed, and semen-preservation infrastructure in the eastern belt and a veterinary college in the district;

Government, having considered the matter, hereby accord administrative sanction / order that —

(1) a modern dairy products / value-addition and processing plant (or capacity

- expansion) shall be established in the Chittur belt through Milma/MRCMPU;
- (2) a cattle-feed manufacturing unit shall be set up in Chittur using locally available maize and agricultural residues;
- (3) a frozen-semen / semen-preservation and AI-strengthening centre (with sexed-semen and embryo-transfer facilities) shall be established through KLDB / the Department;
- (4) the establishment of a KVASU Veterinary and Animal Sciences College in Palakkad/Chittur shall be examined and processed; and
- (5) fodder development (maize/azolla/TMR), bulk milk coolers, mineral-mixture supply, herd-health camps, high-genetic-merit semen and cattle insurance shall be strengthened in the belt.

By order of the Governor,

Secretary to Government

To The Director of Dairy Development; the Director of Animal Husbandry;
the Managing Director, KLDB; the Chairman, Milma / MRCMPU;
the Vice-Chancellor, KVASU.
Copy to: Co-operation Department; the MLA, Chittur.

Petition 4 — Special Status and Pollution-Category Parity for the Coir (De-fibring & Pith) Industry in Chittur

To: Shri P.K. Kunhalikutty Hon'ble Minister for Industries & Commerce, Government of Kerala Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: 1. Shri Ramesh Chennithala, Hon'ble Minister in charge of Coir 2. The Chairman, Kerala State Pollution Control Board

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Request for special status and pollution-category parity for coir de-fibring and coir-pith processing units in Chittur, so that the coir industry can develop within Kerala instead of migrating across the border to Pollachi (Tamil Nadu).

1. Respected Sir,

Chittur adjoins the Pollachi belt of Tamil Nadu and has abundant coconut and coir-husk availability. Yet the primary coir-processing industry has migrated almost entirely to Pollachi, chiefly because of a **difference in pollution-control classification** between the two States. We pray for a level playing field.

2. The factual position

- 1. The classification gap.** The primary coir processes — **coconut-husk retting, de-fibring, and coir-pith processing** — are treated far more stringently by the Kerala State Pollution Control Board (historically in the **Red / Orange** category) than in Tamil Nadu. In **October 2023 the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board withdrew its earlier "Orange" reclassification and retained coir husk-retting, de-fibring and pith-processing in the "White" (practically non-polluting) category.**
- 2. The consequence.** Because of this gap, the **polluting / primary processes (de-fibring, pith buffering) are carried out in Pollachi**, while only value-addition (mats, yarn, mattings, geotextiles) is done in Kerala. Coir entrepreneurs — including many from Kerala — have set up primary units in Pollachi, taking away investment, jobs and the value of our own coconut husk.
- 3. CPCB norms actually permit a lighter category.** The **CPCB Directions dated 07-03-2016** (No. B-29012/ESS(CPA)/2015-16), issued under **Section 18(1)(b) of the Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974**, harmonised the classification on a **Pollution Index (PI)** basis — **Red (PI ≥ 60), Orange (41–59), Green (21–40), White (≤ 20)** — and this has been carried forward by the **CPCB Directions dated 12-02-2025**. Under this methodology and the current classification, coir is placed at a **much lighter category than Red**: - Coir **fibre / pith processing generating effluent** — **Green**; - Coir fibre / pith processing and manufacture of coir products by **dry process** — **White**; - Only coir **bleaching / dyeing / printing** — **Orange**.

For comparison, the **TNPCB Board Proceedings dated 10-11-2021** briefly moved coir from White to Orange, but this was **withdrawn in 2023**, retaining coconut-husk retting, de-fibring and pith-processing in the **White** category in Tamil Nadu. In other words, a blanket Red/Orange treatment of ordinary de-fibring and dry pith processing in Kerala is **stricter than the CPCB norm requires**, and the Kerala State Pollution Control Board can align (under the same 2016/2025 Directions) without diluting genuine environmental safeguards.

3. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister, in coordination with the Coir portfolio and the Kerala State Pollution Control Board, to:

1. **Re-align the pollution-category of coir de-fibring and dry coir-pith processing** in Kerala to **Green / White**, consistent with the CPCB 2016 methodology and the 2023/2025 classification, so that such units are viable in Chittur while dyeing/bleaching alone remains regulated.
2. Grant **special coir-cluster / coir industrial-zone status for Chittur**, with a Special Purpose Vehicle and a **Common Facility Centre** (mechanised de-fibring, pith washing / block-making with **Zero-Liquid-Discharge and effluent / salinity management**), so that environmental concerns are addressed collectively and cost-effectively.
3. Provide **fiscal incentives** — capital subsidy, interest subvention, and **power-tariff parity with Tamil Nadu** — to attract coir units to Chittur.
4. Ensure a **level playing field with Pollachi** so that the value addition to Kerala's own coconut husk is retained within Kerala, generating local employment.

4. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Comparative note — KSPCB vs. TNPCB coir classification and CPCB norms.
- Annexure B: Estimated husk availability and employment potential in Chittur.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur

Annexure — Draft Government Order (model, for the Government's consideration)

The following is a model draft placed for the Government's consideration. The actual G.O. number, date and file references are to be assigned by the Department.

GOVERNMENT OF KERALA
Abstract

Industries Department — Coir sector in Chittur (Palakkad) — Alignment of the pollution-category of coir de-fibring and dry coir-pith processing with the CPCB Directions, and grant of special coir-cluster status with a Common Facility Centre — Orders issued.

INDUSTRIES (COIR) DEPARTMENT
G.O.(Ms) No. ____/2026/ID Thiruvananthapuram, dated __-__-2026

Read: 1. CPCB Directions dated 07-03-2016 (No. B-29012/ESS(CPA)/2015-16) u/s 18(1)(b) of the Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974, and CPCB Directions dated 12-02-2025.
2. TNPCB proceedings dated 10-11-2021 and their withdrawal (2023).
3. Representation dated 15-07-2026 of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, forwarded by the MLA, Chittur.

ORDER

Whereas the primary coir processes (husk retting, de-fibring, dry pith processing) are treated more stringently in Kerala than the CPCB PI-based norm requires, causing these units and their employment to migrate to Pollachi (Tamil Nadu), where they are in the White category;

Government, having considered the matter, hereby order that —

(1) the Kerala State Pollution Control Board shall re-align the category of coir de-fibring and dry coir-pith processing to Green/White, consistent with the CPCB Directions read above (1), retaining regulation only for bleaching/dyeing;
(2) a special coir-cluster / coir industrial-zone status is accorded to

Chittur, with an SPV and a Common Facility Centre (mechanised de-fibring, pith washing/block-making with Zero-Liquid-Discharge and salinity management);

(3) capital subsidy, interest subvention and power-tariff parity with Tamil Nadu shall be extended to coir units in Chittur; and

(4) the Industries and Coir Directorates shall ensure a level playing field so that value addition to Kerala's coconut husk is retained within the State.

By order of the Governor,

Secretary to Government

To The Director of Industries & Commerce; the Director of Coir Development; the Chairman, Kerala State Pollution Control Board.

Copy to: the Minister for Coir; Environment Dept.; the MLA, Chittur.

Petition 5 — Simplify Fertilizer (Urea) Procurement for Genuine Farmers while Preventing Diversion

To: Shri M. Liju Hon'ble Minister for Co-operation, Government of Kerala Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: 1. Shri T. Siddique, Hon'ble Minister for Agriculture 2. Shri Anoop Jacob, Hon'ble Minister for Food, Civil Supplies & Consumer Affairs

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Request to simplify the procurement of urea and other subsidised fertilizers for genuine farmers — especially the elderly and tenant cultivators — while strengthening safeguards against diversion to the wrong persons.

1. Respected Sir,

Primary Agricultural Co-operative Societies (PACS) and co-operative outlets are the main channel through which our farmers buy fertilizer. The present procedure, though well-intentioned, has become **burdensome for genuine farmers** while still leaving gaps that allow diversion. We pray for a simpler, safer system.

2. The factual position

- 1. The current procedure — the exact position.** Fertilizer sale and movement are governed by the **Fertilizer (Control) Order, 1985** made under the **Essential Commodities Act, 1955**. The Union Department of Fertilizers introduced **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) in Fertilizers from October 2016** (pilot), launched the **Integrated Fertilizer Management System (iFMS) in June 2016**, and **completed the pan-India rollout on 1 March 2018**. Under the **Aadhaar-enabled Fertilizers Distribution System (AeFDS)**, all subsidised fertilizers — **urea, DAP, MOP, super-phosphate, etc.** — can be sold only through **Aadhaar-linked Point-of-Sale (PoS) machines with biometric authentication**, the buyer being identified via **Aadhaar / Kisan Credit Card / Voter ID**. Notably, the Department's own guidelines provide that the crop/area recommendation is **not binding** and sale is on a **"no-denial mode"** — a principle that should protect genuine farmers from being turned away for want of documents.
- 2. The difficulties on the ground.** In Palakkad, farmers report: - **Repeated demands for documents** — Aadhaar, and in practice **land-tax receipts / land records** — at every purchase; - **Fingerprint-authentication failures**, especially for **elderly farmers** and manual labourers; - **Exclusion of tenant / lease cultivators**, who till land they do not own and cannot readily produce land documents; - **Network / technical glitches** at PoS terminals, and problems with small-quantity purchases.
- 3. The genuine concern.** At the same time, safeguards are needed so that subsidised fertilizer is **not diverted** to non-agricultural / industrial use, bulk hoarders, or across the State border to the wrong persons.

3. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister for Co-operation (through whom the PACS network functions), in coordination with Agriculture and Civil Supplies, to:

- 1. Introduce a one-time verified "Farmer ID / registration"** — issued through the PACS and linked once to the farmer's **Aadhaar, land / registered-lease record and Soil Health Card** — so that documents such as land-tax receipts **need not be produced at every purchase**; the PoS simply reads the pre-verified entitlement.

2. **Permit biometric alternatives** (OTP / face authentication) and allow an **authorised family member or registered nominee** to purchase on behalf of elderly, ill or differently-abled farmers.
3. **Recognise registered tenant / lease cultivators** (through Padasekhara Samithis / lease registers / cultivation certificates from the Krishi Bhavan) so that landless-but-genuine farmers are not excluded.
4. **Do not insist on the land-tax receipt at each sale** once the one-time registration is complete.
5. **Strengthen anti-diversion safeguards** — enforce **crop-wise / area-wise entitlement ceilings** in the PoS / iFMS, flag abnormal or bulk purchases, and audit — so that fertilizer reaches only genuine cultivators and is blocked from wrong persons and cross-border diversion.
6. **Ensure adequate buffer stock and upgraded PoS connectivity** at PACS in Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara during the peak sowing season.

4. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Instances of document-related hardship (with dates / outlets).
- Annexure B: List of PACS outlets in the Chittur belt and their PoS status.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur

Annexure — Draft Government Order (model, for the Government's consideration)

The following is a model draft placed for the Government's consideration. The actual G.O. number, date and file references are to be assigned by the Department.

GOVERNMENT OF KERALA
Abstract

Co-operation Department — Sale of subsidised fertilizers through Primary Agricultural Co-operative Societies (PACS) — One-time Farmer Registration to simplify procurement for genuine farmers, and strengthened safeguards against diversion — Orders issued.

CO-OPERATION DEPARTMENT
G.O.(Ms) No. ____/2026/Co-op Thiruvananthapuram, dated __-__-2026

Read: 1. The Fertilizer (Control) Order, 1985 (under the Essential Commodities Act, 1955).
2. DoF DBT/AeFDS framework (iFMS, June 2016; pan-India w.e.f. 01-03-2018), providing for sale on "no-denial mode."
3. The Kerala Co-operative Societies Act, 1969.
4. Representation dated 15-07-2026 of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, forwarded by the MLA, Chittur.

ORDER

Whereas genuine farmers — especially the elderly and tenant cultivators — face hardship from repeated document demands and biometric failures at the point of sale, while diversion to wrong persons must be prevented;

Government, having considered the matter, hereby order that, through the co-operative (PACS) network —

- (1) a one-time verified "Farmer Registration / ID," linked once to Aadhaar, land / registered-lease record and Soil Health Card, shall be issued, so that documents (including land-tax receipts) are not demanded at every purchase;
- (2) biometric alternatives (OTP / face authentication) and purchase by an

- authorised family member / registered nominee shall be permitted for the elderly, ill and differently-abled;
- (3) registered tenant / lease cultivators (via Padasekhara Samithis / lease registers / Krishi Bhavan certificates) shall be recognised as eligible;
- (4) the land-tax receipt shall not be insisted upon at each sale once the one-time registration is complete;
- (5) crop-wise / area-wise entitlement ceilings shall be enforced in the PoS/iFMS, with flagging of bulk/abnormal purchases and audit, to block diversion and cross-border leakage; and
- (6) PACS in Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara shall be assured buffer stock and upgraded PoS connectivity during the peak season.

By order of the Governor,

Secretary to Government

To The Registrar of Co-operative Societies; the Director of Agriculture Development & Farmers' Welfare.

Copy to: Agriculture Dept.; Food & Civil Supplies Dept.; the MLA, Chittur.